Geometry originated from two Greek words, geo, meaning earth and metron meaning measure. Geometry means earth measure. Around 600 B.C.(BCE), Thales of Miletus was the first to use deductive methods to develop geometric concepts. The Greek Mathematician, Pythagoras continued the systematic development of Geometry.

DO YOU KNOW?

Example 4.1

With the help of a ruler and compass, draw a line segment PQ = 5.5cm.

Solution

- Draw a line ' l ' and mark a point 'P' on it as shown in Fig. 4.10.



Fig. 4.10

- Measure 5.5 cm using compass as shown in Fig. 4.11 placing the pointer at '0' and the pencil pointer at 5.5 cm.

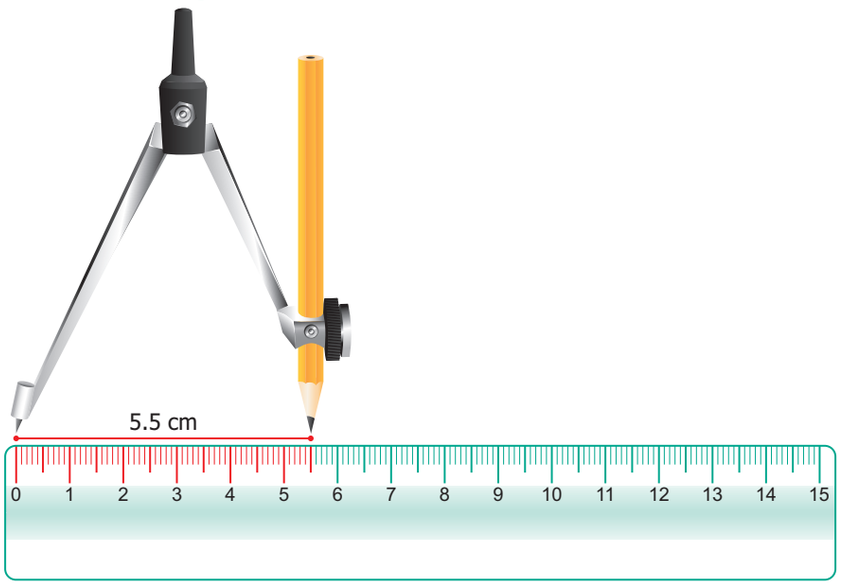


Fig. 4.11

- Place the pointer of the compass at ' P ' then draw a small arc on the line 'l ' with the pencil pointer (Fig. 4.12). It cuts the line ' l ' at a point and name that point as 'Q' (Fig. 4.13).



Fig. 4.12

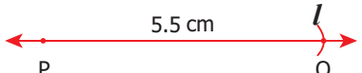


Fig. 4.13

- Now, PQ is the required line segment of length 5.5 cm.

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